
LESSON 28**FILM MEDIA IN SUBCONTINENT AND PAKISTAN (II) & ITS EFFECTS**

More activities of foreigners made Bombay the centre of film world right in the beginning. But the part of the subcontinent which spearheaded in film arts was Lahore. It will not be wrong to say that most talent in direction, acting and singing was generated in the Lahore film studios before partition.

Here we will talk in detail how the film art flourished in Lahore before partition and how this one distinguished mean of mass communication fared in Pakistan after independence.

Pakistan film history from 1896-1947

Pakistan shared its film history with India (Bharat) from 1896 to 1947. Lahore produced many films and a big number of Pakistani artists debuted in this period.

Pakistani artists before 1947

The first silent film from Lahore was **The Daughter of Today** released in 1924 and the inaugural **Punjabi or talkie** film from Lahore was **Heer Ranjha** in 1932. (Alam Ara was released in 1931, which means Lahore was going as fast and one top film-home after Bombay in the subcontinent.

Some Memorable Movies from 1913-47

Raja Harishchandra

The Daughter of Today

Alam Ara

Heer Ranjha

Khazanci

Anmol Gharri

Jugnu

First film made with cultural taboos- sans women

Raja Harishchandra was released for public viewing in Coronation theatres, Bombay. The first Indian motion picture, D. G. Phalke's mythological boasted of an all-male star-cast. Even the female lead was played by a man since no woman was willing to be part of the cast.

First ever silent feature film from Lahore

Premier Film Company

The Daughter of Today

Released in: 1924

The first ever silent film from Punjab

Actors: A.K.Kardar, Wilayat Begum, M. Ismaeel, Vijay Kumar, Heera Lal and Master Ghulam Qadir, G.K. Mehta.

M. Ismaeel started his film career from the first ever Lahore made silent film and he was an automatic choice in the first talkie film from Lahore too.

Assistant Director: **Mian Abdur Rasheed Kardar**, was the man who started film making in Lahore. He was hero in first silent film and director of first talkie film.

Inaugural Urdu/Hindi Indo-Pak feature film

Imperial Film Company Presents

Alam Ara

Urdu/Hindi (124 minutes, black & white)

Released on: Saturday, March 14, 1931 (Capital Cinema Lahore)

India's **first talkie film** was released at Bombay's **Majestic** cinema hall. It had seven songs and was 10,500 ft. long and ran for seven weeks. It was a costume drama and romantic film.

Story: A period fantasy that told of the ageing king of Kamarpur, and his two rival queens, Navbahar and Dilbahar, and their rivalry when a fakir predicts that Navbahar will bear the king's heir. Dilbahar unsuccessfully tries to seduce the army chief Adil (Vithal) and vengefully destroys his family, leaving his daughter Alam Ara (**Zubaida**) to be raised by nomads. Eventually, Alam Ara's nomad friends invade the palace, expose Dilbahar's schemes, release Adil from the dungeon and she marries the prince of the realm.

Actors: Zubaida (Alam Ara), Master Vitthal (Adil), J. Sushila (as Sushila), Jillo Bai, Prithviraj Kapoor, Elizer, Wazir Mohammed Khan, Jagdish Sethi and L.V. Prasad

Music: Feroz Shah and B. Irani

Singers: Zubaida, W.M. Khan

First ever Punjabi feature film

Heer Ranjha

Punjabi

Released in: 1932

The first ever Lahore made film.

Actors: Anwari Begum, Rafiq Ghaznavi, Gul Hameed, Lala Yaqoob, M. Ismael, Fazal Shah, Walait Begum.

Anwari Begum and Rafiq Ghaznavi - the grand parent of Salma Agha - played title roles in this memorable film. Rafiq Ghaznavi was a famous musician in the 30s and 40s and Anwari Begum appeared in many films, one of them was **Anmol Ghari**.

Music: Rafiq Ghaznavi

Folk music comes to films

Pancholi Art Pictures

Khazanchi

Released in: 1941

Actors: Ramola, Naring, M. Ismael, Manorma, Ajmal, Janki Das, Durga Khote

Music: Revolutionary music director **Master Ghulam Haidar** changed the whole style of film music from classical Bengali to folk Punjabi music in this mega hit film from Lahore. **Master Ghulam Haidar** introduced Baby Noor Jehan as playback singer in this film first time. (He also introduced Indian diva Lata Mangeshkar in film **Majboor** in 1948).

Mehboob Production Ltd. (Bombay-Lahore)

Anmol Gharri (Urdu/Hindi)

Released in: 1946

Actors: Noor Jehan, Surender, Surayya, Zahoor Raja, Leela Mishra, Anwari Begum, Bhudo Anvari, Murad

Director: Mehboob Khan, one of the greatest film director in the history, was not formerly educated. This film is special because it brought almost a revolution in subcontinent film world.

Music: One of the most memorable and melodious film by Noushad Ali from the 40s. **Naushad Ali** is regarded as one of the greatest Music Directors of Indian Cinema.

Assistant: Ghulam Ahmad (Pakeeza fame)

Lyrics: Tanvir Naqvi was a relative of Madam Noor Jehan and a very successful lyricist...

Singers: **Noor Jehan** was the most impressive film personality in the Indo-Pak film history. She was dominating since her debut as a child star (1935).

Surayya was another famous singer/actress from the 40s and 50s. Born in Lahore, she debuted as a child star with Taj Mahal (1941).

Shamshad Begum was the first generation of top Punjabi film singers (followed by Zubaida Khanum (in the 50s) and **Madam Noor Jehan** (from 40s-90s), respectively). One can't forget Shamshad's mega hit Punjabi songs as:

- Batti baal ke Banerey utte rakhni aan
- Meri lagdi kise na wekhi, te tutdi nu jugg janda
- Ni tutt jaye Rail Gadiye, too rok leya Chann mera

- Jutt Kurdian toon darda mara

Mohammad Rafi and **Surindra** – all from Punjab, Lahore.

Film songs:

Tera Khilona tuta Balik, hai qismat ne tujh ko...	Mohammad Rafi
Aaja meri barbad mohabbat ke sahare ...	Madam Noor Jehan
Mere bachpan ke saathi mujhe bhool na jana...	Madam Noor Jehan
Jawan hai mohabbat, haseen hai zamana...	Madam Noor Jehan
Kya mil geya Bhagwan tumhe dil ko dukha ke...	Madam Noor Jehan

The Last Big "Pakistani" film before partition

Shoukat Arts Productions

JUGNU

Urdu/Hindi

Released on: 1947

This film was the last big film by Madam Noor Jehan and her husband director Shaukat Hussain Rizvi before partition. It was a big musical and romantic film. Madam Noor Jehan was on peak of her film career as singer and film heroine. Dillip Kumar and Mohammad Rafi got breakthrough from this film.

Actors: **Dilip Kumar** - the acting legend - got breakthrough from this mega hit film. He was born in Peshawar...

Music: **Feroz Nizami**, completed hat trick of three great musical film, first Jugnu in 1947, then Chann We in 1951 and Dopatta 1952 - all with Noor Jehan, & **G. A. Chishti** was a legendary musician in Punjabi films. He dominated Pakistani film music until the beginning of the 70s.

Singers: Madam Noor Jehan, Shamshad Begum.

Mohammad Rafi was a legend and he left behind a rich legacy of songs in Urdu/Hindi, Punjabi and many other languages. Started his singing career from Lahore...

Roshan Ara Begum was acclaimed the best exponent of Kirana gharana style of khayal singing in the subcontinent...

Pakistani artists started their film careers before 1947

A.R.Kardar (actor/director)	Daughters of Today	1924
M. Ismael (actor)	Daughters of Today	1924
Rafiq Ghaznavi (musician)	Heer Ranjha	1932
Ghulam Mohammad (actor)	Madhuri	1933
Zahoor Shah (actor)	Majnoo	1935/1933
Mukhtar Begum (singer/actress)	Naveli Dulhan	1933
Noor Mohammad Charlie (comedian)	Nadra	1933
A. Shah Shikarpuri (comedian)	Fadaye Toheed	1934
Nazir (actor/director)	Aab-e-Hayyat	1934
Master Ghulam Haidar (musician)	Sanjog ki Seerhi	1935
Najmul Hassan (actor)	Jawani ki hawa	1935
Noor Jehan (singer/actress)	Pind di Kurri	1935
S.M. Yousuf (director)	Bharat ka Laal	1935
Rekha (actress)	Neela	1935
Kumar (actor)	Hamari Betian	1936
Ajay Kumar (actor)	Mard ka Bacha	1936
G.A.Chishti (musician)	Sohni Mehinwal	1937
Agha Salim Raza (actor)	Gul Bakawli	1939
Ajmal (actor)	Gul Bakawli	1939
Khursheed Anwar (musician)	Kurmai	1940

Gul Zaman (actor)	Mard-e-Punjab	1940
Najam Naqvi (director)	Puttar Millan	1940
Zahoor Raja (actor)	Pooja	1940
Majeed (actor)	Sandesa	1940
Ragni (actress)	Himmat	1940
W.Z. Ahmad (director)	Ek Raat	1942
Masood Pervez (actor/director)	Mangti	1942
Shoukat Hussain Rizvi (director)	Khandan	1942
Hamaliya Wala (actor)	Kis ki Bivi	1942
M. Sadiq (director)	Namastey	1943
Sheikh Iqbal (actor)	Champa	1945
Sharif Nayyar (director)	Laila Majnu	1945
Rasheed Attre (musician)	Sheerin Farhad	1945
Meena Shori (actress)	Rutt Rangeeli	1945
Asha Posley (actress)	Champa	1945
Renuka Devi (actress)	Ghulami	1945
Feroz Nizami (musician)	Ammar Raj	1946
Master Inayat Hussain (musician)	Kamli	1946
Luqman (director)	Hamjoli	1946
Nisar Bazmi (musician)	Jamna Paar	1946
Nashaad (musician)	Dildar	1947
Nasreen (actress)	Ek Roz	1947
Shah Nawaz (actor)	Elan	1947
Sudhir (actor)	Farz	1947
Santosh (actor)	Ahensa	1947
Rehana (actress)	Saajan	1947
Talish (actor)	Saraye ke baad	1947
Ilyas Kashmiri (actor)	Malka	1947
Tufail Farooqi (musician)	Dekho Jee	1947
Fateh Ali Khan (musician)	Director	1947

First Color film:

Ardeshir Irani's *Kisan Kanya* (1937) was the first color film. Sohrab Modi's *Jhansi Ki Rani* (1953) was the first Techni-color film shot in India.

After partition

1948

Inaugural Pakistani film.

Teri Yaad (Urdu)

Teri Yaad became the first ever released film but not the first film production in Pakistan. It was completed in a record time. Lahore was the third biggest film center in sub-continent - after Bombay and Calcutta - and there were many films under production in 1947

Released in: Perbhat (Sanobar) Cinema, Lahore on August 7th, 1948. It was an Eid-ul-Fitar Day.

Teri Yaad was a dead flop film and the only attraction was film hero Nasir Khan, who was brother of the legendry Dillip Kumar. Asha Poslay was introduced as heroine, but she never became a successful film heroine. Her father Nath, was music director of this film.

Music: Inayat Ali Naath

Lyrics: Qateel Shafai became the first film poet in Pakistan. He had a long and successful film career...

Singers: Munawar Sultana, Asha Poslay & Ali Bakhs Zahoore

1949**Pheray**

First Silver Jubilee Punjabi Film.

The first ever Punjabi and the sixth film in the list of released Pakistani films celebrated a great success in cinemas. Veteran Producer and Director Nazir got the honour to become the first Silver Jubilee film maker. He was also the only choice as hero in 1949.

Pakistan's first ever produced Punjabi film **Pheray** was a re-make of Nazir's Indian Urdu/Hindi film "*Gaon ki Gori*" (1945). It was a big musical hit and the Music Director G. A. Chishti wrote, composed and recorded six songs of this film in a single day! Chishti was also the most productive Music Director in the first 25 years of Pakistan.

Music: G. A. Chishti

Singers: Munawar Sultana & Inayat Hussain Bhatti

Changes the films brought

- Entertainment.
- Cinema houses - a new business.
- Jobs in thousands for acting, direction, music, sets, lighting, recording, cinematography etc.
- Billboards all over in so much color - landscape changed.
- Manifested culture and in return influenced culture – dresses, languages, living style, harmony etc.
- Strong expression against hated figures in society, oppressors- at least can see on screen.
- Boldness, vulgarity, obscenity – the dark side of films.

